VITALITY 12

L-arginine

Amino acid found in food; the body uses it to make nitric oxide



CLASS Amino acid

STUDIED FOR Erectile dysfunction

HUMAN EVIDENCE Small human studies

US STATUS Dietary supplement; not FDA approved for ED

STUDIED FOR

- **Erections** — HUMAN + ANIMAL
- **Growth hormone test** — HUMAN

Results differ between trials. Trials were mostly 30 to 100 men. Several in the pooled analysis combined arginine with other substances.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

L-arginine → Nitric oxide → Vessels relax → Penile blood flow

- **Used by the body** to make nitric oxide, which relaxes blood vessels
- **Erection effects** reported in rat and rabbit studies (animal)
- **Penile blood flow:** unchanged in a 1999 trial, higher in a 2022 trial

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

SMALL HUMAN
LEVEL 3 OF 5

- Pooled: 10 trials, 540 men
- Largest single trial: 98 men, 3 months
- No Phase III trial for ED

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term use for ED
- Dose for ED

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE Not established

ROUTES STUDIED By mouth in ED trials; vein (R-Gene 10 test)

PHARMACOKINETICS Limited human data

SOLD AS Dietary supplement; Rx injection only as R-Gene 10

MONITORED IN TRIALS Erection scores, penile blood flow, nitric oxide markers

SPORT (WADA) Not on the 2026 list

REGULATORY

FDA	Not approved for ED; R-Gene 10 test only
FDA	OTC sexual-performance claims need approval
WADA	Not on the 2026 list

REFERENCES

1. Rhim et al., J Sex Med, arginine for ED meta-analysis, Feb 2019
2. Menafra et al., J Endocrinol Invest, L-arginine in vascular ED, Jan 2022
3. FDA, R-Gene 10 prescribing information (DailyMed), Apr 2024

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